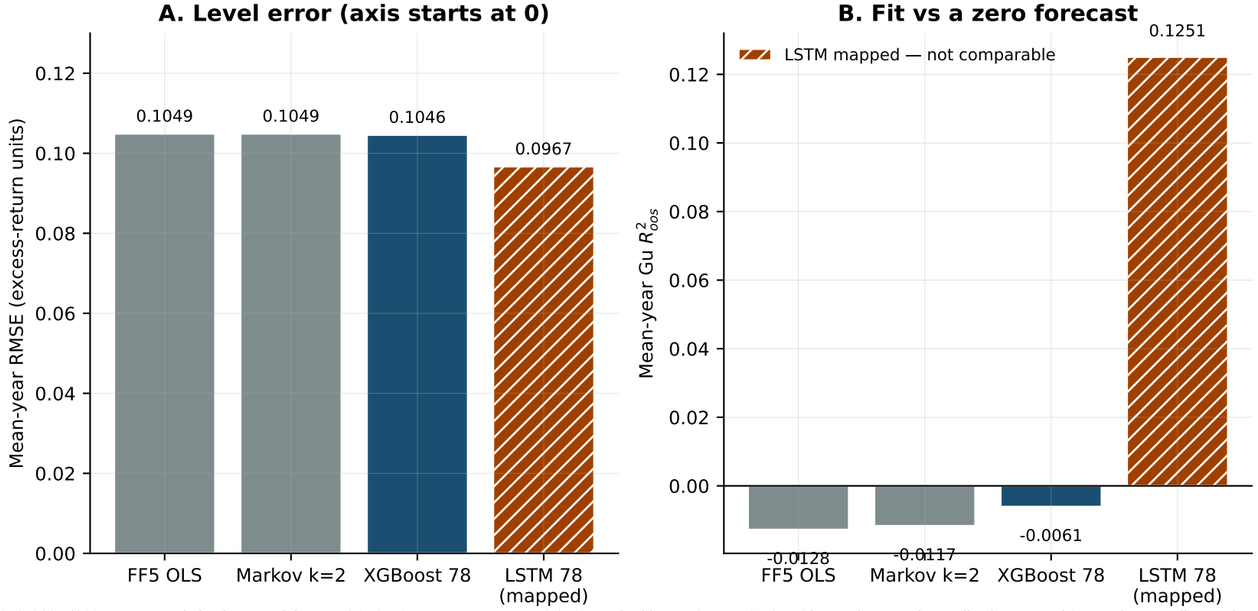
Figure 3.2 Direct level forecasts are a near-tie; hatched LSTM bars are mapped



Eval years 2012–2025 (2025 = 11 months). Direct models n = 76,373; LSTM sequences n = 73,950. Hatched bars: LSTM RMSE/Gu R² insert that month's realised mean and SD, so they are diagnostics, not a horse-race win. Comparable LSTM metrics are IC and long–short (Figure 3.1 / A.2). Source: ff5 dissertation_table_h1; markov k=2 summary; xgb/lstm 78-feature walk-forwards.